

► **Problem:** “Out of memory” Error In Win9x And Win ME

After upgrading the RAM to 512 MB, the system displays an error message stating it’s “out of memory.”

Cause: This is due to a bug in Windows 9x and Windows ME systems that have more than 512 MB of RAM. This is because the OS reserves too much memory to be used as temporary cache. The reservation is based on the amount of RAM. Therefore, when you use any Windows application, or at Windows startup itself, this error message pops up; the system is not actually out of memory.

Solution/Workaround: Go to **Start > Run** and type in “**sysedit**” and hit [Enter]. The System Configuration Editor window opens; it opens all the system configuration files within its window. Choose the ‘**C:\Windows\system.ini**’ box, and under ‘[vcache]’, enter the following parameter:

MaxFileCache=524288

The above value is in KB, and the amount should be less than or equal to 512 MB. If you do not have [vcache] in your system.ini file, then make the entry towards the end of the file:

[vcache]

MaxFileCache=524288

Save the file and reboot the machine.

► **Problem:** Virtual Memory Error

There can be two types of error arising from virtual memory:

1. A STOP error stating “**DRIVER_IRQL_NOT_LESS_OR_EQUAL**”
2. System low on virtual memory

Cause: Let’s take the first case. Virtual memory is the swap space used by Windows that creates an illusion of larger system memory. This space is allocated by the OS under the primary partition (in most cases). NT calculates this space as RAM + 12 MB, whereas Windows 2000 and Windows XP counts it as 1.5 times the amount of RAM. A STOP error occurs when the area on your hard disk that contains pagefile.sys (the virtual memory) gets corrupted.

When the real system memory is low and the page file thus allotted is also low, applications that use RAM extensively issue a ‘System low on virtual memory’ error as the requirement shoots over the total memory (RAM + virtual memory) available to the operating system.